



United States
Attorney's Office
District of New Jersey



New Jersey Doctor Charged With Distributing Opioids In Exchange For Sexual Favors And Defrauding New Jersey Medicaid

Friday, July 18, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, District of New Jersey

NEWARK, N.J. – A New Jersey doctor was charged with distributing opioids without a legitimate medical purpose, soliciting sexual favors from patients in exchange for opioid prescriptions, and defrauding New Jersey Medicaid by billing for visits that never happened, U.S. Attorney Alina Habba announced.

Ritesh Kalra, 51, of Secaucus, New Jersey, was charged in a 5-count Complaint with 3 counts of distributing opioids outside the usual course of professional practice, not for a legitimate medical purpose, and in exchange for sexual favors, and 2 counts of healthcare fraud. Kalra made his initial appearance yesterday before U.S. Magistrate Judge André M. Espinosa in Newark federal court and was released on home incarceration and an unsecured \$100,000 bond. He also is prohibited from practicing medicine and prescribing medication and will be required to shut down his medical practice while the case is pending.

“Physicians hold a position of profound responsibility—but as alleged, Dr. Kalra used that position to fuel addiction, exploit vulnerable patients for sex, and defraud New Jersey’s public healthcare program. By allegedly exchanging prescriptions for sexual favors and billing Medicaid for ghost appointments, he not only violated the law but endangered lives. Our Office will continue to pursue those who turn their medical licenses into tools for personal gain and sexual gratification.”

- U.S. Attorney Alina Habba

"When we seek medical advice and treatment from doctors, we have to assume they have our best interests in mind. This investigation, conducted by the FBI and our partners, illustrates that Dr. Kalra had little regard for actually taking care of his patients. As alleged, he instead used them for his sexual gratification and, in the process, defrauded the state of New Jersey. A patient's relationship and trust in a physician, while at their most vulnerable, is not something to be exploited for personal gain. We are asking anyone who may be a victim or knows someone who was treated by Dr. Kalra to get in touch with our office at 1-800-CALL-FBI," stated Special Agent in Charge Stefanie Roddy.

"In the fight against the opioid crisis, we often witness the painful struggles of those battling addiction. Rather than offering help, Dr. Kalra exploited his victims at their most vulnerable—using opioids as leverage in exchange for sexual favors—further deepening their addiction and worsening the crisis" stated DEA New Jersey Special Agent in Charge Cheryl Ortiz. "The DEA will continue to work with our partners in making sure those who abuse their professional oath are held accountable."

"Physicians who recklessly and illegitimately distribute controlled substances undermine critical efforts to battle the opioid crisis and betray their professional responsibility to serve the health and well-being of the public. As alleged, Dr. Kalra took advantage of individuals struggling with addiction all for his own personal gratification," said Special Agent in Charge Naomi Gruchacz of the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services Office of Inspector General (HHS-OIG). "HHS-OIG will continue to work with our law enforcement partners to address such abuse to protect patients, communities, and taxpayers from such dangerous conduct."

According to documents filed in the case and statements made in court:

Dr. Kalra, an internist in Fair Lawn, New Jersey, allegedly operated a pill mill out of his medical office, where he routinely prescribed high-dose opioids—including oxycodone—and promethazine with codeine to patients without a legitimate medical purpose. Between January 2019 and February 2025, Kalra issued more than 31,000 prescriptions for oxycodone, including days when he wrote upwards of 50 prescriptions. Several of Kalra's former employees reported that female patients complained that Kalra touched them sexually and demanded sexual favors of them, including oral sex, in order to obtain their prescriptions. One patient described being sexually assaulted by Kalra on multiple occasions, including forced anal sex during clinical appointments. Another patient continued to receive opioid prescriptions from Kalra when the patient was incarcerated at Essex County Correctional Facility and had no contact with Dr. Kalra.

Kalra also allegedly billed for in-person visits and counseling sessions that never occurred. As part of the health care fraud scheme, Kalra's electronic medical records allegedly contained false progress notes listing fabricated dates of service, and included examination notes that were generally identical from visit to visit and did not record vital signs.

Each count of distributing controlled substances carries a maximum penalty of 20 years in prison and a \$1 million fine. Each count of health care fraud is punishable by a maximum potential penalty of 10 years in prison and a fine of \$250,000, or twice the gross profit or loss caused by the offense, whichever is greatest.

Individuals who believe they may be victims of Dr. Kalra or have information about this case may contact the FBI at 1-800-CALL-FBI (225-5324) or by email at NK-Victim-Assistance@fbi.gov.

U.S. Attorney Habba credited the following law enforcement organizations with the investigation leading to yesterday's charges: the Federal Bureau of Investigation, under the direction of Special Agent in Charge Stefanie Roddy; the Drug Enforcement Administration, under the direction of Special Agent in Charge Cheryl Ortiz; the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services Office of Inspector General, under the direction of Special Agent in Charge Naomi Gruchacz; the Internal Revenue Service—Criminal Investigation, under the direction of Special Agent in Charge Jenifer Piovesan; the Social Security Administration Office of Inspector General, under the direction of Special Agent in Charge Amy Connelly; the New Jersey Office of the Attorney General Division of Criminal Justice; and the Fair Lawn Police Department.

The Government is represented by Assistant U.S. Attorneys Katherine M. Romano and Jessica R. Ecker and of the Health Care Fraud and Opioids Enforcement Unit in Newark.

The charges and allegations contained in the complaint are merely accusations, and the defendant is presumed innocent unless and until proven guilty.

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Defense counsel: Michael Baldassare, Esq.

[kalra.complaint.pdf](#)

Updated July 21, 2025

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HEALTHCARE FRAUD

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USAO - New Jersey

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